

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Alexi Shostakov

OCCUPATION

Espionage agent for Soviet Union; later for People's Republic of China

BASE

Various secret KGB bases in USSR; later a military base in the People's Republic of China

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT 220 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Red

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers #43 (August 1967)

Brilliant athlete and test pilot, trained in espionage techniques and hand-to-hand combat by the KGB. Disc on Red Guardian's belt could be detached and used as a throwing weapon; magnetic force returned the disc after throwing.

After encountering the Avengers, the Red Guardian battles Hawkeye, Black Widow's lover.

RED GUARDIAN

A talented athlete and test pilot—and husband to Natasha Romanoff (BLACK WIDOW)—Alexi Shostakov faked his dead and trained to become a top KGB operative codenamed Red Guardian, modeled after a Soviet hero from World War II. While Natasha became disillusioned with her KGB masters and defected to the USA, Alexi remained loyal and increasingly ruthless and vindictive. He was thought to have given his life to save her and CAPTAIN AMERICA, but he turned up alive again years later, trying to bring Natasha to justice for betraying her homeland.

Dr. Tara Belinsky became the next Red Guardian and even joined the DEFENDERS for a while. When PRESENCE gave her radioactive powers, she changed her name to Starlight. Four other Red Guardians followed after her, each athletic men. The latest was recently seen working with the WINTER GUARD. **AD, MF**



The Red Guardian's identity is revealed.

RED RAVEN

FIRST APPEARANCE Red Raven Comics #1 (August 1940)

REAL NAME Unknown

OCCUPATION Adventurer BASE Mobile

HEIGHT 6 ft WEIGHT 180 lbs EYES Black HAIR Red

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Can fly using anti-gravity metallic wings, which can also deflect bullets and fire energy beams

Raised by a lost tribe of Inhumans known as the Bird-People, on a hovering island in the Atlantic, Red Raven was a heroic member of the World War II-era Liberty Legion. After the war, he placed himself and his people into suspended animation to prevent aggression between them and humanity. Later, the Angel (see ARCHANGEL) discovered Red Raven, who made it appear that his island had been destroyed to ensure the privacy of the Bird-People. His daughter Dania has also assumed the identity of Red Raven. **DW**



RED SKULL see opposite page

RED WOLF

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers #80 (September 1970)

REAL NAME William Talltrees

OCCUPATION adventurer BASE American Southwest

HEIGHT 6 ft 4 in WEIGHT 240 lbs EYES Brown HAIR Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superhuman senses. Skilled hand-to-hand combatant. Expert tracker and archer. Employs a coup stick (a 6 ft wooden staff used as a bo or javelin), tomahawk and knife.

The first Red Wolf is believed to have tamed the first horse and conquered the American plains for the Cheyenne. The second was Johnny Wakeley, a Cheyenne orphan who forged peace between his people and the US Cavalry. The current Red Wolf is Will Talltrees who grew up on the Cheyenne Reservation, in Wolf Point, Montana. After his family was murdered by businessmen, he begged the gods for the power to avenge them. The Wolf Spirit Owayodata heard his prayers. Following the legend of previous Red Wolves, Talltrees later trained a wolf until they almost thought as one. **TD**



REDEEMER

FIRST APPEARANCE Incredible Hulk Vol. 2 #343 (May 1988)

REAL NAME Craig Saunders

OCCUPATION Former demolitions expert BASE New York

HEIGHT 6 ft 1 in WEIGHT 205 lbs EYES Brown HAIR White

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Bonded with combat suit armed with twin plasma cannons on each hand, a rocket and grenade launcher, and rocket boots enabling 30 minutes of flight.

After joining the military as a demolitions expert, Craig Saunders' world came crashing down when he failed to defuse a bomb in an airport terminal, causing the death of two civilians. Desperate, he joined a new paramilitary team called the Hulkbusters, but their effort to defeat the HULK also ended in disappointment. Taking advantage of Saunders' despair, the LEADER persuaded him to become the Redeemer and integrated Saunders' body into a formidable yellow combat suit. Sadly, redemption was not to be his—Saunders died during his very first confrontation with old greenskin. **AD**

